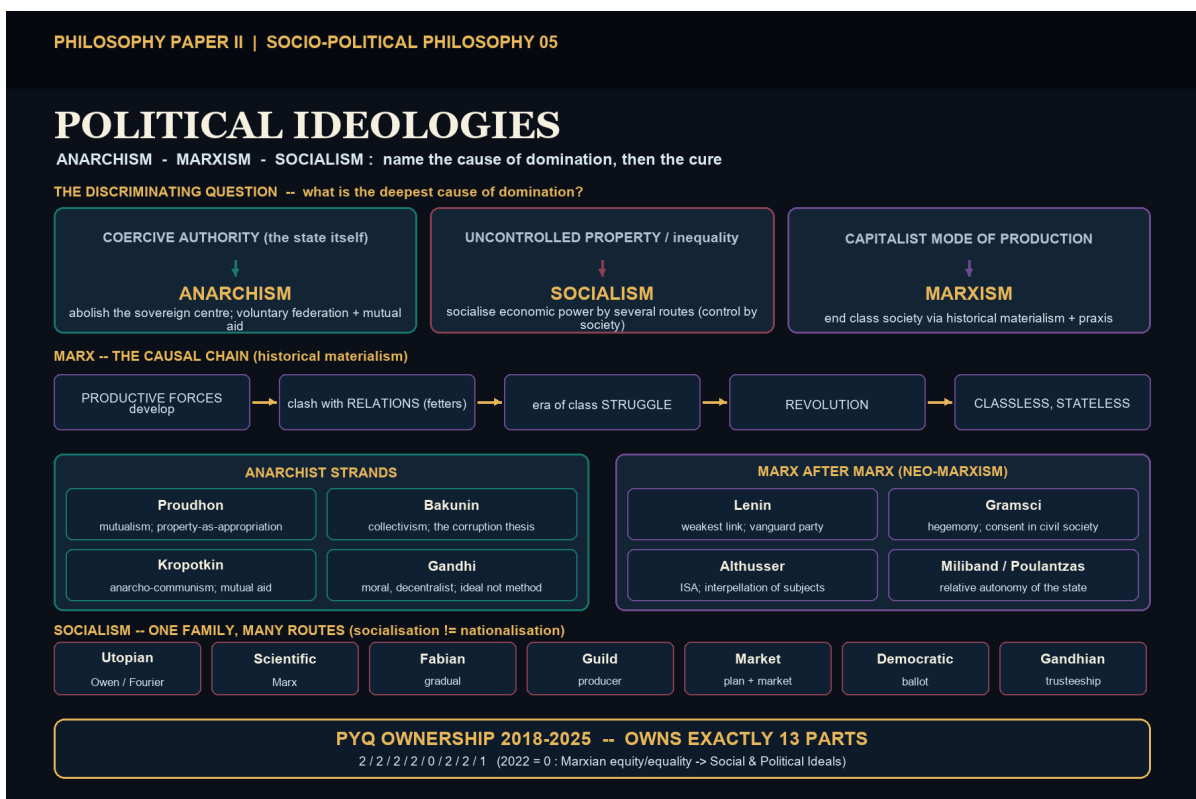


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

POLITICAL IDEOLOGIES - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Socio-Political Philosophy 05

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

POLITICAL IDEOLOGIES - Layered Solved-Practice Workbook - Philosophy Paper II Socio-Political Philosophy 05

Workbook Source Audit

- Exact PYQ wording, year and marks: local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank, 2018-2025.
- Exactly 13 owner questions (2018:2, 2019:2, 2020:2, 2021:2, 2022:0, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:1).
- Ownership discipline: the 2022 Marxian equity/equality 15-marker (Social and Political Ideals, hence no 2022 owned part here), the caste-specific Gandhi/Ambedkar stems (Caste), the 2020 Gandhian-social-development 20-marker (Development and Social Progress), the authority-tinged democracy stems (Sovereignty) and the 2018 liberal-democracy 10-marker (Forms of Government) are kept separate and not double-owned here.
- Model solutions authored at examiner grade: thesis -> doctrine in canonical terms -> named evidence unit (P1-P12) or Indian example -> objection/reply/residual -> graded verdict, each closing with a "Why this earns marks" note.
- MCQs: 40 core plus 8 remedial, exactly 48, strict A-B-C-D rotation 12 times.
- Original Mains: one solved 10-marker, one solved 15-marker and one solved 20-marker.
- Provenance discipline observed throughout: Lenin, Gramsci, Althusser, Miliband (1969) and Poulantzas (1973) by position/title and year only; Marx's 1844 Manuscripts, the 1848 Manifesto, the 1859 Preface and the 1875 Critique of the Gotha Programme by title and year only; the Directive Principles (Articles 38, 39, 43) are dated non-justiciable facts, not proof; no regime, party or period is characterised.
- Scaffolding discipline: the concept-of-ideology apparatus and the liberalism/conservatism comparison are marked context beyond the syllabus core (Anarchism; Marxism and Socialism).
- No current-affairs anchor is used (no verified 2026 development forced); relevance is static and syllabus-driven.
- Final consolidated register notes are intentionally excluded from this workbook.

Practice Design

The workbook sequence is the 13 exact verified PYQs -> 40 core MCQs -> 8 remedial MCQs -> original 10/15/20-mark Mains practice. There are no register notes and no canonical apparatus block in this workbook.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED EVIDENCE (P1-P12) / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION / REPLY / RESIDUAL -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 13 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the local Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II bank for 2018-2025. This clause owns exactly 13 primary parts (2018:2, 2019:2, 2020:2, 2021:2, 2022:0, 2023:2, 2024:2, 2025:1). Ownership discipline (explained, not silently double-owned): the 2022 Marxian equity-versus-equality 15-marker (Q2c) is owned by Social and Political Ideals, which is why this clause has no owned part in 2022; the 2019 Gandhi-versus-Ambedkar secular-democracy 20-marker (Q4a) and every caste-specific Gandhi/Ambedkar stem are owned by Caste; the 2020 Gandhian-social-development 20-marker (Q2a) is owned by Development and Social Progress; the Austin- and Kautilya-authority democracy stems are owned by Sovereignty; and the 2018 liberal-democracy 10-marker (Q1a) is owned by Forms of Government. None of those is counted here.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Do you subscribe to the political ideology of Anarchists ? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. I subscribe to anarchism's CRITIQUE -- its refusal to identify order with sovereign command and its demand that coercive authority justify itself function by function -- but not to the strong CONSTRUCTIVE claim that a complex modern society can dispense with all public authority; the defensible position is philosophical, not insurrectionary, anarchism.

- **The doctrine, exactly.** Anarchism holds that coercive political authority, paradigmatically the sovereign state, lacks adequate moral justification, and that order can rest on voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. Its engine is the burden-of-justification argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality (1); the state claims a territorial monopoly of law and coercion (2); it demands obedience for a command's LEGALITY, not its rightness (3); that subordinates my judgment to another's institutional will (4); so the state bears a burden it cannot discharge (5).

- **Why I accept the critique (evidence P9).** Property and the state can function as an institutional power of appropriation and domination (Proudhon), and concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (Bakunin), while cooperation and mutual aid are genuine sources of order (Kropotkin). Historical existence is not moral legitimacy.

- **Why I stop short (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection: without public authority, scale, public goods and persistent aggressors go unaddressed. Reply: anarchism rejects DOMINATION, not coordination -- delegated, recallable, federated administration can operate across scales. Residual: the HIDDEN-AUTHORITY problem is unanswered -- expertise, status and economic power return after formal offices are abolished, so a society still needs accountable public power to check them.

Verdict (asymmetric). Anarchism's critique of unaccountable coercion is stronger than its account of the order that should replace the state; I subscribe to its standard -- that authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited and accountable -- while holding that the standard is best met by constitutionalised public authority, not by its abolition.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it answers "do you subscribe?" with a graded yes/no (accept the critique via P9, reject the strong constructive claim via the hidden-authority residual) and closes on the asymmetric verdict, not a slogan.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2018 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent ONLY CONDITIONALLY: they are consistent where collective ownership genuinely ENLARGES each person's real self-development and democratic control, and they become inconsistent -- the emancipatory claim defeating itself -- where "collective" power hardens into bureaucratic command.

- **Reframe "freedom".** Marx rejects a purely negative liberty (non-interference) that leaves formal rights operating over radically unequal social conditions. His positive ideal is non-domination PLUS self-development: the capacity to engage in conscious, social, creative activity, of which alienated labour deprives the worker (evidence P3 -- estrangement from product, activity, species-being and others).

- **The consistency argument.** If the means of production are brought under genuinely social, democratic control, then the structural coercion of the wage-relation is removed and freedom is EXTENDED to those the market subordinated -- collective ownership is the condition, not the enemy, of real freedom.

- **The self-defeat condition (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection (bureaucratic domination): state ownership can become ownership by officials, and a transitional "dictatorship of the proletariat" can entrench rather than wither (the strongest historical objection at §2.9). Reply (M. N. Roy's radical humanism): retain Marx's critique of exploitation but reject economic determinism and party absolutism and restore

individual reason and ethical autonomy, since concentrated power cannot reliably serve emancipation. Residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse, so accountability, plural organisation and civil liberty must be built INTO the transition, not postponed.

Verdict (conditional). Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent as an IDEAL of collective self-development, and inconsistent in any form that subordinates the individual to class, party or historical necessity; the doctrine survives only if it constitutionalises the freedom it promises.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it turns "consistent?" into the "only if... otherwise self-defeats" conditional (P3 + §2.8), brings M. N. Roy as the internal Indian reply, concedes the adverse record, and grades rather than answers yes/no.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: Evaluate Mahatma Gandhi as a political anarchist.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhi is a QUALIFIED political anarchist: a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL, but a pragmatic reformer in political METHOD -- so he shares anarchism's suspicion of the centralised coercive state without sharing its insurrectionary anti-theism or class war.

- **The anarchist affinity.** Gandhi's swarāj begins with self-rule; political freedom is insecure without mastery of desire, non-violence and local self-government. His preference for decentralised village republics and a state reduced to a minimum places him squarely within the anarchist family's rejection of concentrated coercive authority.

- **Where he diverges (evidence P10).** His non-violence, trusteeship, religious ethics and constructive programme REPLACE class war and anti-theism; means must prefigure ends, so a violent, centralising path cannot produce a non-violent, decentralised order. This is a moral anarchism of transformation, not a Bakuninite programme of abolition.

- **The critical qualification.** Gandhi does not call for insurrection against the state; he accepts a minimal state and works through mass civil action and constructive reform. So his anarchism is an ideal-limit, approached by moral and institutional transformation, not a demand to abolish authority now.

Verdict. Evaluated as a political anarchist, Gandhi qualifies in aspiration -- decentralised swarāj, minimal state, distrust of coercive centralism -- but not in method, since he pursues the ideal through non-violence and reform rather than the abolition of the state; "anarchist in ideal, reformer in method" is the exact formula.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it grades the label (affinity via swarāj/minimal state; divergence via P10 means-ends and non-violence) and lands the precise "ideal vs method" verdict instead of a flat yes or no.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2019 Q3(c), 15 marks

Question: What do you consider to be the future of Marxism in the context of the prevalent free-market economy?

Model solution

Thesis. In a prevailing free-market economy the FUTURE of Marxism lies in its survival as a diagnostic and critical framework, not as an infallible prediction of collapse or a blueprint for a command economy: what persists is the analysis; what fails is the timetable and the party-state remedy.

- **What the free market vindicates in Marx.** Concentration of capital, commodification, precarity, recurrent crises and the ideological normalisation of market relations remain live phenomena the analysis still explains (evidence P2 -- the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations; P4 -- structural exploitation through surplus value, argued as a relation, not via the contested price theory).

- **What the free market falsifies.** Revolution did not first triumph in the most advanced economies; welfare compromise, universal franchise and political organisation altered the trajectory. Marxism is an explanatory framework, not an infallible schedule -- and the neo-Marxist turn already absorbed this:

causal weight was RELOCATED into ideology and the state (P6 Gramsci's hegemony; P8 Poulantzas's relatively autonomous state) rather than the doctrine abandoned.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: the collapse of command economies

refutes Marxism. Reply: it refutes the unaccountable party-state, not the critique of exploitation; the two must be separated. Residual: Marxism supplies no internal safeguard against the transitional state entrenching itself -- that gap is why its political future depends on democratic and constitutional reconstruction.

Verdict (relocation). The future of Marxism under free markets is as a REFINED critical tradition: its diagnosis of concentration, precarity and ideological reproduction retains force; its predictive schedule and command-economy remedy do not; so it will endure as analysis and critique rather than as a governing programme -- with no verdict passed here on any particular country.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it splits diagnosis (P2/P4, still explains) from prediction and remedy (falsified), uses the neo-Marxist relocation (P6/P8) as the survival mechanism, and grades without commenting on any actual regime.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2020 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Do you think that the prevailing pandemic will lead to anarchism in society? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. No -- a pandemic does not "lead to anarchism", because anarchism is not the breakdown of order but a normative doctrine of order WITHOUT sovereign coercion; a crisis may produce temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or, revealingly, a surge of voluntary MUTUAL AID, but neither amounts to the considered political ideology.

- **The decisive distinction.** Anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule and may mean disorder; anarchism is a critique of domination that PROPOSES non-coercive order through association, mutual aid and federation. Conflating the two is the exact trap the stem sets.

- **What a pandemic actually shows (evidence P9, used carefully).** Emergencies simultaneously (a) expand STATE authority (public-health coercion, mobilisation) and (b) reveal dense VOLUNTARY cooperation -- neighbourhood networks, community kitchens, mutual-aid groups -- which illustrate Kropotkin's claim that mutual aid is a genuine source of social order, not an accidental exception. But such networks show limited, local capacities; they do not prove a complex society can eliminate public authority.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: crisis distrust of the state could snowball into anti-statism. Reply: distrust of a particular government is not the principled anarchist rejection of the state as such; and pandemics typically strengthen demands FOR competent public authority, not for its abolition.

Verdict. A pandemic may generate episodes of anarchy and impressive mutual aid, but it does not generate anarchISM; if anything it displays BOTH the indispensability of accountable public authority AND the real, bounded power of voluntary cooperation -- which is the anarchist insight without the anarchist conclusion.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it refuses the anarchy/anarchism conflation up front, reads the pandemic through P9 (mutual aid, bounded), and grades to "shows the insight, not the conclusion" rather than answering a careless yes.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2020 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: How far is Marxism as a philosophical doctrine relevant in the present context? Justify your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxism as a PHILOSOPHICAL doctrine remains substantially relevant -- as a method, a critique and a theory of ideology -- even where its 19th-century predictions and 20th-century political implementations have failed; relevance must be judged by diagnostic power, not by the fate of any regime.

- **The philosophical core that survives.** Historical materialism reads social

formations through productive forces, relations of production and class (evidence P2); the theory of alienation diagnoses the estrangement of labour under commodified production (P3); the critique of ideology explains how contingent, class-bound relations come to appear natural and inevitable (and Gramsci's hegemony, P6, and Althusser's interpellation, P7, extend this into culture and subject-formation). These are analytical instruments, not dated slogans.

- **Where it needs correction.** Economic reductionism is a real tendency: caste, religion, gender and nationalism have relative autonomy and cannot be derived from class alone -- so class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT, especially in India (§2.9). The reply treats these as materially embedded powers rather than mere epiphenomena, expanding the analysis through hegemony and social reproduction.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: authoritarian outcomes discredit the doctrine. Reply: separate the critique of exploitation from the unaccountable transitional state; the philosophy is not the regime. Residual: the doctrine offers no internal safeguard against that state -- the strongest standing objection.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). The philosophical analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; the institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and the theory supplies no internal guard against it. Marxism is therefore relevant as critique and method, refined rather than refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it isolates the philosophical core (P2/P3/P6/P7), concedes the necessary-not-sufficient limit and the authoritarian residual, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split rather than a yes/no on "relevance".

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss anarchism as a political ideology. Is it possible to dispense with political authority completely? Give reasons for your answer.

Model solution

Thesis. Anarchism is a coherent political ideology built on a single powerful argument -- that coercive authority must justify itself and cannot -- but it is NOT possible to dispense with political authority COMPLETELY in a complex society; the tenable conclusion is the abolition of unaccountable DOMINATION, not of all public coordination.

- **Anarchism as an ideology (the argument).** It diagnoses domination as flowing from coercive hierarchy itself and prescribes voluntary association, mutual aid and federation. The burden-of-justification argument runs in five steps (autonomy/equality -> the state's territorial coercion monopoly -> obedience demanded for legality not rightness -> subordination of judgment -> unmet burden). Its strands differ on property and transition: mutualism (Proudhon), collectivist (Bakunin), anarcho-communism (Kropotkin), individualist and philosophical anarchism, which denies an automatic duty to obey without demanding insurrection.

- **The strongest case for dispensing with authority (evidence P9).** The state has historically organised war, repression and structural domination; federated, delegated and recallable administration can coordinate without a sovereign centre; so much "necessary" authority is really entrenched power.

- **Why complete dispensal fails (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objections: the security dilemma (private violence, persistent aggressors), scale and public goods, and above all HIDDEN AUTHORITY -- expertise, status and economic power return once formal offices vanish. Replies neutralise the first two (coordination is not domination). Residual: the hidden-authority problem is unanswered, and it requires accountable PUBLIC authority to police domination inside voluntary associations. Bakunin's own warning -- that a revolutionary state breeds a new elite -- cuts BOTH ways: unaccountable power returns whether it is called a state or not.

Verdict (asymmetric). Anarchism succeeds as a CRITERION -- authority is legitimate only so far as it is justified, limited, decentralised and accountable -- and fails as a total programme; we cannot dispense with political authority completely, but we can, and should, subject it relentlessly to that anarchist test.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it expounds anarchism as an argument with named strands, presses the strongest case (P9), then answers "completely?" through the hidden-authority residual and Bakunin's double-edged warning, closing on the asymmetric criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2021 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Discuss the distinctive features of Gandhian Socialism and its contemporary relevance.

Model solution

Thesis. Gandhian socialism is a distinctive NON-VIOLENT, DECENTRALIST socialism that seeks equality and freedom from exploitation without class war or centralised industrial collectivism; its contemporary relevance lies in its ethics of means-ends unity and ecological restraint, even as its central mechanism -- trusteeship -- remains institutionally fragile.

- **Distinctive features.** It combines non-possession, TRUSTEESHIP, bread labour, decentralised production, village swarāj and SARVODAYA (the welfare of all). Its argument: property carries a social obligation; production should meet need without degrading labour, community or nature; and the means must embody the non-violent end (evidence P10 -- means determine ends). It rejects BOTH unrestricted capitalism AND violent, centralised collectivism.

- **How it differs from Marxian socialism.** Where Marx locates the root in class exploitation and prescribes revolutionary transition, Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrial civilisation and prescribes moral transformation, trusteeship and constructive work; self-rule begins with ethical self-restraint, not seizure of the means of production.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: trusteeship depends on the voluntary moral conversion of owners and may simply preserve unequal ownership. Reply: Gandhi treats trusteeship as a non-violent DIRECTION of transition, not a celebration of possession. Residual: without enforceable institutions the objection stands -- Ambedkar's warning against relying on the conscience of the dominant is decisive, and Gandhian socialism needs institutional backing to be more than exhortation.

- **Contemporary relevance.** Its emphasis on decentralisation, need-based production, dignity of labour and non-violent means speaks directly to ecological limits, over-consumption and the alienation of scale -- a live corrective to productivism.

Verdict. Gandhian socialism is distinctive precisely in fusing equality with non-violence and decentralisation; it is contemporarily relevant as an ETHICAL and ecological critique, but delivers on that promise only when trusteeship is underwritten by enforceable institutions rather than left to conscience.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it names the trusteeship/swarāj/sarvodaya cluster, contrasts it with Marxian socialism, presses the voluntary-conversion objection to a residual (Ambedkar), and grounds relevance in means-ends + ecology.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2023 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the anarchist's view that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust."

Model solution

Thesis. The anarchist claim that "all States always and everywhere are illegitimate and unjust" states the doctrine at its strongest and most UNIVERSAL -- and that universality is also its weakness: the burden-of-justification argument shows the state must always JUSTIFY itself, but not that every state everywhere maximally FAILS to; the defensible core is philosophical anarchism, not this absolute.

- **Reconstruct the claim.** It rests on the five-step argument: legitimate authority must respect autonomy and equality; the state claims a territorial monopoly of coercion; it demands obedience for legality, not rightness; this subordinates individual judgment; therefore the state bears an unmet burden of justification (evidence P9 -- property/authority as institutionalised domination; Bakunin's thesis that concentrated

power corrupts).

- **Why the UNIVERSAL form overreaches.** "Always and everywhere" collapses the distinction between a standing DUTY TO JUSTIFY and a verdict of GUILT. A liberal constitutional state that limits itself by rights, consent, accountability and the rule of law satisfies far more of the justification burden than an absolutist one -- so states differ in legitimacy by degree; a blanket "all... always" ignores that gradient.

- **The disciplined reply (philosophical anarchism).** The strongest anarchism is PHILOSOPHICAL: it denies an AUTOMATIC duty to obey the state simply because a command is legal, while allowing critical allegiance to institutions that earn it. That preserves the moral insight (no unearned authority) without the false empirical claim that every state is equally unjust.

Verdict (criterion). Judged by the justification of coercion, the anarchist is right that NO state is self-legitimizing and every state must answer for its coercion; but "all, always, everywhere, illegitimate" is too strong -- legitimacy is a graded achievement, and the tenable position is that authority is presumptively suspect until justified, not that it is universally condemned.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it "critically examines" by reconstructing the claim via P9, isolating the fatal word "always/everywhere", and rescuing the defensible philosophical-anarchist core with a graded criterion verdict.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Explain Historical Materialism and discuss its relevance in the context of social development and change.

Model solution

Thesis. Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive forces, relations of production, class structure and political-ideological institutions; it remains highly relevant to social development and change AS A METHOD, provided its base-superstructure relation is read non-mechanically and supplemented where class alone is insufficient.

- **The doctrine as a causal chain (evidence P2).** (1) Human beings must produce the means of life; (2) production occurs through definite social relations; (3) productive forces develop within those relations; (4) existing relations eventually become FETTERS on further development; (5) the conflict between forces and relations becomes social and political struggle; (6) a new mode of production can emerge through that struggle. The elements: productive forces (capacity), relations of production (ownership/control), mode of production (their unity), base/superstructure (a relation, NOT a one-way switch) and class struggle (the motor of transformation).

- **Relevance to social development and change.** It supplies a materialist account of WHY social orders change -- technological and productive development destabilising inherited property relations -- and of how law, politics and ideology are anchored in social labour and power. Extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's reproduction (P7), it explains not only revolution but the STABILITY of orders through consent and subject-formation.

- **Objection -> reply -> residual.** Objection: economic determinism -- caste, religion, gender and nationalism cannot be read off the base. Reply: historical materialism can treat these as materially embedded powers with relative autonomy, not epiphenomena. Residual: in India especially, class analysis is NECESSARY BUT INSUFFICIENT -- caste operates through status, endogamy and social reproduction that class alone cannot derive; say this before the objection is put.

Verdict (necessary-not-sufficient). As a research programme, historical materialism remains a powerful explanation of social development and change; its limit is reductionism, repaired by reading the base-superstructure relation reciprocally and adding the independent mechanisms of caste, gender and culture -- so it is refined, not refuted.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it runs P2 as six numbered premises (not slogans), states the base/superstructure caution pre-emptively, extends via P6/P7, and grades with the necessary-not-sufficient verdict tuned to Indian social change.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.

Model solution

Thesis. For Marx, ALIENATION is the estrangement of the worker from their own productive life under conditions of private property and the division of labour -- a structural condition of capitalist production, broader than low pay, in which labour that should be self-realising becomes an external, compelled and dispossessed activity.

- **The four dimensions (evidence P3, from the 1844 Manuscripts).** The worker is estranged (1) FROM THE PRODUCT, which confronts them as another's property; (2) FROM THE ACTIVITY of labour, which is externally compelled rather than self-realising; (3) FROM SPECIES-BEING, as conscious creative activity is reduced to a means of survival; and (4) FROM OTHER PERSONS, as workers compete and social relations assume commodity form.

- **The mark-bearing distinction.** Alienation is BROADER THAN LOW WAGES: a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others. So the remedy is not merely higher pay but restored control over the activity and ends of work -- which is why alienation, not just inequality, is central to Marx's critique.

- **Objection -> reply.** Objection: species-being assumes a controversial universal human essence. Reply: it can be reconstructed MINIMALLY -- persons require meaningful agency, social recognition and control over their central activities -- without positing a fixed metaphysical essence.

Verdict. Alienation names a genuine and enduring feature of commodified, hierarchically controlled work; its diagnostic reach extends well beyond the 19th-century factory to contemporary labour wherever activity, product and purpose are severed from the producer -- which is why it remains Marx's most portable concept.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- as an EXPOSITION it leads with the definition and the four dimensions (P3), makes the "broader than low wages" distinction the centrepiece, adds only one controlled objection/reply, and keeps exposition dominant as the directive demands.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.

Model solution

Thesis. Socialism and communism are distinct ideologies, not synonyms: SOCIALISM names a broad family that subjects productive property to social control by many possible routes, while COMMUNISM (in Marxist vocabulary) names a specific END-STATE -- a classless, stateless order distributing according to need -- reached through a transition; the difference is one of scope, ownership regime, the fate of the state and the principle of distribution.

- **Run the shared axes in parallel (evidence P11).**

- **PROPERTY:** socialism = social control in varied forms (state, cooperative, market, moral); communism = common ownership with classes abolished.

- **STATE:** socialism may retain a democratic, active state; communism expects the political state, as an instrument of class domination, to lose its class function.

- **DISTRIBUTION:** socialism = by contribution, need or a mix; communism (higher phase) = according to need, once the "bourgeois" measure of contribution is transcended (evidence P12 -- equity is not equality; the lower phase still pays by contribution).

- **METHOD:** socialism = revolutionary OR gradual/parliamentary; communism = reached through the transitional phase Marx calls the dictatorship of the proletariat.

- **The vocabulary caution.** In Marxist usage "socialism" often denotes the transitional LOWER PHASE on the way to communism; in wider political theory it names the whole family. State which sense you are using, or the comparison collapses.

Verdict. They are distinct: communism is a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state within the Marxist tradition, whereas socialism is the broader family of doctrines that socialise economic power by diverse routes and need not abolish the state at all -- so all communists are socialists, but not all socialists are communists.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it COMPARES on fixed axes (property/state/ distribution/method) via P11 and P12 rather than writing two summaries, flags the lower-phase/higher-phase vocabulary, and lands the "all communists are socialists, not vice versa" verdict.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a Political Ideology.

Model solution

Thesis. Evaluated as a political ideology, Marxism is exceptionally strong as a METHOD, a CRITIQUE and a theory of IDEOLOGY, and correspondingly weak as a PREDICTION and as an institutional programme; its enduring value is diagnostic, its recurring failure political -- and a fair evaluation must keep the two apart.

- **What Marxism is.** Simultaneously a method (dialectical-historical analysis), a critique (exploitation, alienation, commodity relations, ideology), a theory of change (contradiction and class struggle) and a political project (collective emancipation). As ideology in the DESCRIPTIVE sense it guides action; in the PEJORATIVE sense it is itself the theory that UNMASKS ideology as the naturalising of class-bound relations.

- **Strengths (evidence).** Historical materialism explains structural change (P2); surplus value shows exploitation as a RELATION, not unfair bargaining, so it survives even where the labour theory of value is contested (P4); the critique of ideology, extended by Gramsci's hegemony (P6) and Althusser's interpellation (P7), explains how orders secure consent.

- **Objections, each with reply and residual (§2.9).** (1) Economic determinism -> treat caste/gender/culture as materially embedded, relatively autonomous powers -> residual: class is necessary but insufficient, sharply so in India. (2) Failed prediction (revolution not in advanced economies) -> Lenin's weakest-link and vanguard revision (P5) -> residual: the vanguard has no mechanism subordinating party to class (substitutionism). (3) Authoritarian outcome -> build liberty and accountability into the transition -> residual: the historical record stays adverse and the theory offers no internal safeguard. (4) Class reductionism -> anti-caste and feminist analyses identify distinct mechanisms.

- **The neo-Marxist relocation.** Later Marxism keeps the materialist mechanism but relocates causal weight into party, culture and state form (P8 -- the relatively autonomous state) -- refinement, not abandonment.

Verdict (diagnosis/remedy split). Marxism's analysis of concentration, exploitation and ideological reproduction retains force; its institutional remedy -- an unaccountable transitional state -- does not, and it supplies no internal guard against that outcome. As an ideology it is therefore best judged a powerful CRITIQUE in permanent search of a safe political form.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it evaluates on BOTH senses of ideology, banks the strengths (P2/P4/P6/P7), runs all four §2.9 objections to residuals with the P5 revision, adds the P8 relocation, and closes on the diagnosis/remedy split, not a verdict on any regime.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 48 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-40 are core coverage - four per subtopic across the ten subtopics; Questions 41-48 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 12 times.

MCQ 1

The single question that most efficiently sorts anarchism, socialism and Marxism is:

A. what is the deepest cause of domination -- coercive authority, uncontrolled property, or the capitalist mode of production B. which ideology is the oldest historically C. which ideology has the largest number of followers today D. whether the ideology originated in Europe or in Asia

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The canonical 'discriminating question' identifies the diagnosed cause of domination (authority / property / mode of production), which then fixes the cure.

MCQ 2

The 'pejorative' or Marxian sense of the word ideology refers to:

A. any organised belief-system that guides political action B. a socially rooted framework that makes historically specific, class-bound relations appear natural, universal or inevitable C. a fixed authoritative teaching handed down by a party D. a concrete list of policy measures for an election

Correct answer: B

Explanation: In the Marxian critique (canonical 2.6), ideology is 'not merely a lie' but a framework naturalising contingent relations -- distinct from the neutral, descriptive sense.

MCQ 3

Ideology is distinguished from PROPAGANDA principally because:

A. ideology is always false while propaganda is always true B. propaganda contains a theory of history while ideology does not C. ideology offers a diagnosis and a picture of the good order, whereas propaganda is manipulative persuasion indifferent to truth D. the two are exact synonyms in political theory

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Ideology (diagnosis + picture of the good order + strategy) differs from propaganda (manipulation indifferent to truth), and from philosophy, doctrine and programme.

MCQ 4

The 'end of ideology' thesis is best assessed as:

A. a proven fact after 1991 B. a description that applies only to anarchism C. a claim confined to economic policy D. an empirically weak claim, since continued anarchist, Marxist, nationalist and ecological mobilisation persists, and the announcement is itself an ideological move

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The persistence of ideological mobilisation falsifies the 'end of ideology'; declaring ideology finished is itself an ideological gesture.

MCQ 5

The distinction between 'anarchy' and 'anarchism' is that:

A. anarchy is the absence or collapse of effective rule (possibly disorder), while anarchism is a normative critique of domination that proposes non-coercive order B. anarchy is a normative doctrine while anarchism means chaos C. the two terms are interchangeable D. anarchy refers to socialism and anarchism to communism

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Conflating anarchy (disorder) with anarchism (a considered doctrine of order without a sovereign centre) is the canonical trap.

MCQ 6

The core of the anarchist argument against the state is that:

A. the state is simply too large to administer efficiently B. the state demands obedience because a command is legally authoritative rather than independently right, thereby subordinating one person's judgment to another's institutional will C. the state cannot collect enough taxes to function D. monarchy is preferable to a republic

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The burden-of-justification argument turns on obedience being owed to legality, not rightness -- an unmet burden the state cannot discharge.

MCQ 7

Which pairing of anarchist thinker and emphasis is correct?

A. Kropotkin -- property is theft as an institutional power B. Proudhon -- concentrated power corrupts both ruler and ruled C. Bakunin -- concentrated power deforms ruler and ruled (the corruption thesis) D. Bakunin -- mutual aid as the primary source of social order

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Bakunin supplies the corruption thesis; Proudhon targets property-as-appropriation; Kropotkin supplies mutual aid -- so only the Bakunin-corruption pairing is right.

MCQ 8

A key PRESUPPOSITION of anarchism, correctly stated, is that:

A. human beings are always benevolent and never selfish B. social coordination logically requires a single sovereign centre C. historical existence by itself establishes an institution's moral legitimacy D. coordination does not logically require a sovereign centre, since federations and associations can perform many coordinating functions

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Anarchism's claim is institutional, not a naive psychology: coordination can occur through federation without a final coercive superior.

MCQ 9

Anarcho-communism (Kropotkin) is distinguished from mutualism (Proudhon) chiefly by:

A. favouring common ownership with distribution according to need, rather than possession and exchange without exploitative property B. supporting a strong centralised state C. rejecting all forms of cooperation D. endorsing hereditary monarchy

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Anarcho-communism = common ownership + distribution by need (communes, mutual aid); mutualism = possession and exchange through contracts and associations.

MCQ 10

The STRONGEST internal objection to anarchism, which a defensible anarchism must concede, is:

A. that anarchists dislike all cooperation B. the 'hidden authority' problem -- expertise, informal status and economic power return even after the state is abolished C. that anarchism has no named thinkers D. that anarchism requires a hereditary ruler

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Security and scale objections have replies; the hidden-authority objection is the serious residual, demanding scrutiny of domination inside voluntary associations.

MCQ 11

The safest exam formulation of Gandhi's relation to anarchism is that he is:

A. a full Bakuninite revolutionary anarchist B. in no sense connected to anarchism C. a moral and decentralist anarchist in ideal, but a pragmatic reformer in political method D. an advocate of a strong centralised industrial state

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Gandhi's swaraj and minimal-state decentralism give an anarchist affinity, but non-violence, trusteeship and constructive work make him a reformer in method.

MCQ 12

Philosophical anarchism is best characterised as the view that:

A. every state must be overthrown by immediate insurrection B. anarchism requires collective ownership of all property C. anarchism is identical with civil disobedience D. there is no automatic duty to obey the state, though critical allegiance to institutions may coexist with the critique

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Philosophical anarchism denies an automatic duty to obey without demanding insurrection -- the discriminating reply to the 'all states are unjust' stem.

MCQ 13

In Marx's causal chain, social and political struggle arises when:

A. the developing productive forces come into conflict with existing relations of production, which become fetters B. rulers simply become morally corrupt C. the population grows beyond available land D. citizens lose religious faith

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Historical materialism locates the motor in the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations of production, not in moral or demographic factors.

MCQ 14

The correct UPSC-safe statement of the base-superstructure relation is that it is:

A. a mechanical one-way cause from economy to every idea B. a relation in which base and superstructure interact reciprocally, so the fair criticism is a TENDENCY toward reductionism, not a crude determinism Marx never qualified C. a claim that ideas determine the economy D. irrelevant to Marxist theory

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Marx allows reciprocal effects and political agency; the legitimate criticism is a tendency to economic reductionism, stated before the objection is raised.

MCQ 15

Presenting 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' as Marx's own fixed three-step law is:

- A. an accurate summary of Capital
- B. the central claim of historical materialism
- C. a common error, since that formula is a later textbook shorthand and not Marx's own fixed law
- D. a phrase coined by Kropotkin

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The triad is a later shorthand; asserting it as Marx's formula signals a second-hand reading -- a canonical trap.

MCQ 16

'Relations of production' in historical materialism refers to:

- A. the tools and technology available to a society
- B. the total population engaged in farming
- C. the level of scientific knowledge
- D. the ownership, control and class relations that determine who commands and appropriates

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Relations of production = ownership/control and class relations; productive forces are the capacity to produce; their unity is the mode of production.

MCQ 17

Marx's four dimensions of alienation are estrangement from:

- A. the product, the activity of labour, species-being, and other persons
- B. the state, the church, the family, and the market
- C. land, labour, capital, and enterprise
- D. reason, emotion, will, and memory

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The 1844 Manuscripts identify estrangement from product, from the act of labour, from species-being, and from other persons.

MCQ 18

A crucial feature of Marx's concept of alienation is that:

- A. it applies only to unemployed workers
- B. it is broader than low wages, since a well-paid worker can remain alienated where labour, product and purpose are controlled by others
- C. it disappears once the minimum wage is raised
- D. it is identical to legal inequality

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Alienation concerns control over the activity and ends of work, so higher pay alone does not remove it -- the mark-bearing distinction.

MCQ 19

According to Marx, surplus value arises because:

- A. capitalists steal wages outright through fraud
- B. workers are paid more than the value they create
- C. the value produced during the working day can exceed the value represented by wages, and the remainder is appropriated by owners of capital
- D. the state taxes workers too heavily

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Exploitation is structural, not theft: under a formally free contract the labour done can create more value than the wage returns, and that gap is appropriated.

MCQ 20

The distinction between exploitation and inequality, for Marx, is that:

A. they are the same thing B. inequality concerns the relation of production while exploitation concerns distribution C. exploitation can only occur in feudalism D. exploitation concerns the social RELATION of production (control and appropriation), while inequality concerns the DISTRIBUTION of holdings, so redistribution can leave exploitative control intact

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Because exploitation is about control and appropriation, a welfare transfer that reduces inequality need not touch the exploitative relation.

MCQ 21

For Marx, the 'dictatorship of the proletariat' denotes:

A. a transitional political supremacy of the working class, not in itself a textual licence for permanent one-party dictatorship B. the permanent rule of a single vanguard party C. rule by a hereditary monarch advised by workers D. the immediate and final abolition of all authority

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The phrase names a transitional class supremacy; reading it as a warrant for a permanent party-state is a canonical overreach.

MCQ 22

In the Marxist critique, ideology is best defined as:

A. simply a deliberate lie told by rulers B. a socially rooted framework through which historically specific relations appear natural, universal or inevitable C. any scientific theory of economics D. the constitution of a state

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Ideology is 'not merely a lie' but the naturalisation of contingent, class-bound relations -- the pejorative Marxian sense.

MCQ 23

Marx's critique of 'equal legal right' is that:

A. all legal rights should be abolished immediately B. formal equality is always sufficient for justice C. formally identical rules operating over radically unequal social conditions can conceal unequal productive power, so formal equality may mask domination D. equity and equality mean exactly the same thing

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Marx distinguishes formal from substantive equality: the same rule applied to unequal conditions can entrench, not remove, domination.

MCQ 24

Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent, according to the canonical file, only if:

A. the individual is fully subordinated to the party B. private property is expanded C. the state is abolished overnight D. collective ownership genuinely enlarges real self-development and democratic control, rather than becoming bureaucratic command

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The self-defeat condition: emancipation requires that collective power expand freedom; bureaucratic command defeats the emancipatory claim.

MCQ 25

Lenin's revision of classical Marxism holds that:

- A. the imperialist chain breaks at its weakest link, and revolutionary consciousness must be brought from outside by a vanguard party under democratic centralism
- B. revolution must occur only in the most industrially advanced economy
- C. spontaneous worker struggle automatically produces revolutionary consciousness
- D. the state should be strengthened permanently

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Lenin relocates revolution to the weakest link and argues spontaneous struggle yields only trade-union consciousness, so a vanguard party is needed.

MCQ 26

Gramsci's concept of hegemony refers to:

- A. rule maintained purely by police and army
- B. moral, intellectual and cultural leadership securing the CONSENT of the subordinated through civil society (school, church, press, culture)
- C. the economic base determining ideas mechanically
- D. the abolition of all intellectuals

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Hegemony is consent won and lost in civil society by organic intellectuals -- the first substantial concession of relative autonomy to the superstructure.

MCQ 27

Althusser's concept of interpellation describes how:

- A. the state uses only violence to rule
- B. the economy directly produces all laws
- C. ideology 'hails' individuals as subjects, so that in recognising themselves in assigned roles they are constituted as subjects who freely do what the structure requires
- D. workers spontaneously develop revolutionary consciousness

Correct answer: C

Explanation: For Althusser ideology is a material practice; ISAs reproduce relations of production by interpellating individuals as subjects -- explaining stability better than change.

MCQ 28

In the Miliband-Poulantzas debate, Poulantzas argues that the capitalist state has:

- A. no autonomy whatsoever from individual capitalists
- B. complete and unlimited autonomy from all class forces
- C. authority derived solely from divine right
- D. relative autonomy from any particular fraction of capital, enabling it to act for capital-in-general and appear to represent 'the people', so long as that autonomy remains RELATIVE

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Poulantzas answers Miliband's instrumentalism with relative autonomy; stretched past 'relative', the analysis stops being Marxist and becomes pluralism.

MCQ 29

The relationship between socialism and Marxism is best stated as:

- A. socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control, of which Marxism is one revolutionary and materialist member
- B. socialism and Marxism are identical
- C. Marxism is broader than socialism
- D. socialism rejects all social control of property

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Socialism names the whole family (utopian, Marxian, Fabian, guild, market, Gandhian); Marxism is one member of it.

MCQ 30

Which correctly distinguishes socialism, communism and social democracy?

A. all three abolish the state immediately B. socialism = social control in varied forms; communism (Marxian higher phase) = common ownership with classes abolished and distribution by need; social democracy = private property retained but regulated with tax-transfer C. communism retains private property while social democracy abolishes it D. social democracy is the revolutionary transition to communism

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The axes property/state/distribution/method separate the family (socialism), the classless end-state (communism) and the regulated-capitalism route (social democracy).

MCQ 31

A distinctive feature of Gandhian socialism is:

A. violent seizure of the means of production B. centralised heavy industrialisation C. trusteeship, bread labour, decentralised production and sarvodaya, seeking equality without class war or centralist collectivism D. unrestricted free-market capitalism

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Gandhian socialism combines non-possession, trusteeship, decentralisation and village swaraj, rejecting both unrestricted capitalism and violent centralised collectivism.

MCQ 32

The canonical warning that 'socialism is not identical with state ownership' means that:

A. socialism requires the monarchy to own all land B. socialism forbids any public sector C. communism and socialism are the same D. socialisation requires control by SOCIETY -- democratic, participatory, accountable -- since nationalisation alone can become ownership by officials (bureaucratic domination)

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Nationalisation without democratic control merely replaces private domination with bureaucratic domination; socialisation means accountable social control.

MCQ 33

The central disagreement between anarchism and Marxism concerns:

A. the state: anarchism would abolish it without a transitional sovereign, while Marxism uses transitional proletarian political power before it withers B. whether capitalism should be retained C. whether human beings can cooperate D. whether religion should be established

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Both target capitalism, but split on the state: immediate abolition (anarchism) vs transitional class power (Marxism) -- the core of the 'dispense with authority' stem.

MCQ 34

Bakunin's prediction against the Marxist transition is that:

A. capitalism will collapse of its own accord without struggle B. a revolutionary workers' state may itself create a new ruling stratum, becoming a new despotism C. the peasantry can never be revolutionary D. religion will disappear automatically

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Bakunin warns the transitional state breeds a new elite -- the anarchist objection Marxists answer by insisting organised class power is needed to defeat entrenched property.

MCQ 35

The core contrast between Marx and Gandhi includes that:

A. both endorse violent revolution B. both reject decentralisation C. Marx locates the root in class exploitation and accepts revolutionary transition, while Gandhi locates it in greed, violence and modern industrialism and insists means must prefigure ends D. Gandhi supports large-scale centralised production

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Marx vs Gandhi divides on violence, industrial scale and the means-ends relation, though both oppose exploitation.

MCQ 36

M. N. Roy's radical-humanist criticism of Marxism proposes to:

A. subordinate the individual entirely to the party B. abandon the critique of exploitation altogether C. restore hereditary authority D. retain Marx's critique of exploitation while rejecting economic determinism and party absolutism and restoring individual reason and ethical autonomy

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Roy is the internal Indian bridge: keep the exploitation critique, drop determinism and party absolutism, recover individual freedom.

MCQ 37

For the objection 'revolution produces dictatorship', the canonical reply-and-residual pairing is:

A. reply: emancipation requires democratic proletarian agency; residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse B. reply: dictatorship is always good; residual: none C. reply: revolution is impossible; residual: capitalism is eternal D. reply: monarchy is preferable; residual: none

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The strongest reply invokes democratic proletarian agency, but the adverse historical record is the honest residual that a graded answer must state.

MCQ 38

Which is a canonical UPSC trap to AVOID?

A. stating that anarchism proposes order without sovereign coercion B. identifying socialism with state ownership, when socialisation actually requires control by society rather than merely by officials C. distinguishing exploitation from inequality D. reading base-superstructure as reciprocal

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Equating socialism with state ownership is a listed trap; socialisation means accountable social control, not ownership by officials.

MCQ 39

The disciplined reply to the all-purpose charge that an ideology is 'utopian' is that:

A. all ideologies should be abandoned as impractical B. only Marxism is utopian C. every ideology contains a regulative picture of a justified order, so the real test is whether feasibility CONSTRAINS rather than replaces the normative claim D. utopianism is always a fatal objection

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Since every ideology (including liberalism) has a regulative ideal, the test is whether feasibility constrains normativity, not whether an ideal exists.

MCQ 40

Treating a welfare scheme, cooperative or statute as PROOF that socialism is true or false is:

- A. the correct method for evaluating ideologies
- B. required by historical materialism
- C. the way Marx settled the question
- D. a canonical error, since these are dated institutional illustrations while the philosophical issue is control, freedom and justice

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Statutes and schemes illustrate what a state has enacted; they cannot settle a philosophical question about control, freedom and justice.

Remedial MCQ 41

Remedial -- a candidate writes 'a pandemic will cause anarchism'. The correct correction is that:

- A. a crisis may cause temporary ANARCHY (disorder) or a surge of voluntary mutual aid, but not anarchISM, which is a normative doctrine of order without sovereign coercion
- B. a pandemic always establishes anarchism permanently
- C. anarchy and anarchism mean the same thing
- D. anarchism means the collapse of all cooperation

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Anarchy (disorder) must not be confused with anarchism (a considered doctrine); crises typically strengthen demands for competent public authority.

Remedial MCQ 42

Remedial -- 'Marx's method is the thesis-antithesis-synthesis law'. The correct correction is that:

- A. this is the central formula of Capital
- B. the triad is a later textbook shorthand, not Marx's own fixed three-step law; Marx's dialectic is materialist, locating contradiction in social life
- C. Marx borrowed it unchanged from Kropotkin
- D. the triad proves economic determinism

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Attributing 'thesis-antithesis-synthesis' to Marx as a fixed law is a canonical trap; his dialectic is materialist and non-mechanical.

Remedial MCQ 43

Remedial -- 'socialism and communism are synonyms'. The correct correction is that:

- A. they are indeed identical in every school
- B. communism is broader than socialism
- C. socialism names the whole family that socialises economic power by diverse routes, while communism (Marxian) names a specific classless, stateless, need-based end-state -- so specify vocabulary and phase
- D. social democracy is the same as communism

Correct answer: C

Explanation: In Marxist usage socialism often denotes the transitional lower phase; in wider theory it names the family. Never treat the two as loose synonyms.

Remedial MCQ 44

Remedial -- 'Marxism is basically the demand for equal incomes'. The correct correction is that:

- A. Marxism is only about wages
- B. Marxism demands identical incomes for all
- C. equality of income is Marx's central category
- D. Marxism's central categories are production, class, exploitation, alienation and praxis -- not equality of income; it criticises the wage-relation, not merely unequal pay

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Reducing Marxism to income equality misses its structural categories; exploitation concerns control and appropriation, not distribution alone.

Remedial MCQ 45

Remedial -- 'the economic base mechanically determines every idea'. The correct correction is that:

A. base and superstructure interact reciprocally, and Marx allows political agency; the fair criticism is a tendency to reductionism, not a determinism he never qualified B. ideas alone determine the economy C. the superstructure has no causal weight at all D. the base-superstructure relation is irrelevant to Marxism

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The base-superstructure relation is reciprocal, not a one-way switch; economic reductionism is a tendency to guard against, not a doctrine Marx asserted crudely.

Remedial MCQ 46

Remedial -- 'Gandhi was simply a Bakuninite anarchist'. The correct correction is that:

A. Gandhi wanted a strong centralised industrial state B. Gandhi is a moral and decentralist anarchist in IDEAL but a pragmatic reformer in METHOD, replacing class war and anti-theism with non-violence, trusteeship and constructive work C. Gandhi rejected swaraj and decentralisation D. Gandhi endorsed violent insurrection against the state

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Gandhi shares an anarchist affinity (decentralised swaraj, minimal state) but diverges on non-violence and method -- 'anarchist in ideal, reformer in method'.

Remedial MCQ 47

Remedial -- 'the capitalist state is completely autonomous from class power'. The correct correction is that:

A. the state has no autonomy at all B. the state's authority is charismatic C. for Poulantzas the state has RELATIVE autonomy that is functional for capital; stretched into COMPLETE autonomy, the analysis ceases to be Marxist and becomes pluralism D. the state is an instrument with no independent action

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Autonomy must remain relative; 'complete' autonomy from class power collapses the Marxist analysis into the pluralist state under another name.

Remedial MCQ 48

Remedial -- 'Marx gives a detailed blueprint of communist institutions'. The correct correction is that:

A. Marx wrote a full constitution for communism B. Marx specified the exact economic plan of the higher phase C. Marx described communist courts and parties in detail D. Marx's account of communism is deliberately limited; he offers no detailed institutional blueprint, distribution 'according to need' being a projected higher-phase principle, not a plan

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Claiming Marx blueprints communist institutions is a canonical error; his account is deliberately sparse, which is why later regimes cannot be read back into him.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

Original Mains 1

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 10 marks - answer in about 150 words - directive: Bring out / Assess

Question: Bring out the difference between the descriptive and the pejorative (Marxian) senses of 'ideology'. Is the 'end of ideology' thesis tenable?

Model solution

Thesis. 'Ideology' carries two senses, and the 'end of ideology' claim collapses under both.

Doctrine. In the *descriptive* (neutral) sense an ideology is any organised belief-system that diagnoses a social ill, pictures a good order and guides action -- liberalism, socialism and anarchism all qualify. In the *pejorative/Marxian* sense (canonical 2.6), ideology is a socially rooted framework that makes historically specific, class-bound relations appear natural, universal or inevitable; it is 'not merely a lie' but a naturalisation of contingency.

Evidence. Marx's claim that the ruling ideas are the ideas of the ruling class expresses the pejorative sense; the neutral sense is what political science uses when it classifies party doctrines.

Assessment. The 'end of ideology' thesis is empirically weak: anarchist, Marxist, nationalist and ecological mobilisation persists, and announcing ideology's death is itself an ideological move that naturalises the status quo.

Verdict. Distinguish the senses first; the thesis fails on its own terms.

MEMORY: Two senses (neutral vs naturalising) + persistence of mobilisation + 'end of ideology is itself ideological' = full marks.

Original Mains 2

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 15 marks - answer in about 250 words - directive: Critically examine

Question: 'Nationalisation is not the same as socialisation.' Critically examine with reference to the socialist tradition.

Model solution

Thesis. Socialism demands control by *society*; nationalisation is only one, potentially self-defeating, route to it.

Doctrine. Socialism is a family of doctrines subjecting productive property to social control for equality, cooperation and welfare (canonical 3.1). Its core is *socialisation* -- democratic, participatory, accountable control -- not merely transferring title to the state. The canonical warning (3.4, evidence-unit P11) is explicit: socialism is not identical with state ownership, and nationalisation without democratic control can become ownership by officials, i.e. bureaucratic domination.

Evidence and distinctions. The family separates on the axes property/state/distribution/method: utopian vs scientific (Marx), Fabian gradualism, guild and market socialism, and Gandhian trusteeship. Communism (Marxian higher phase) abolishes classes and distributes by need; social democracy regulates capitalism through tax-transfer. Across these, the constant is *control by society*, not the legal form of ownership.

Objection and reply. A defender of nationalisation replies that public ownership is a necessary lever against private domination. Reply: necessary perhaps, but insufficient -- if the enterprise is run by an unaccountable bureaucracy, private domination is merely replaced by official domination, and the emancipatory claim is defeated (the socialist self-defeat condition).

Residual. How to institutionalise genuine democratic control at scale remains contested (incentives, information, accountability).

Verdict. The statement is largely correct: nationalisation is a means that becomes socialism only when it delivers accountable social control.

MEMORY: socialisation = control by society; nationalisation without democracy = bureaucratic domination (P11).
State the axes, then the self-defeat condition.

Original Mains 3

Original practice - Socio-Political Philosophy Paper II - 20 marks - answer in about 300 words - directive: Critically examine and assess

Question: Anarchism and Marxism both seek to end domination, yet they divide sharply on the state. Critically examine their disagreement and assess whose diagnosis is the more defensible.

Model solution

Thesis. Anarchism and Marxism share the enemy -- domination rooted in capitalism -- but split on the *state as method*; each diagnosis illuminates what the other obscures, so the defensible verdict is conditional rather than a knock-out.

Common ground. Both reject the existing order as systematically dominating and both project a stateless, classless end. Marxism's classless-stateless communism and anarchism's federated society converge on the goal.

The disagreement. Anarchism (evidence-unit P9: Proudhon on property-as-appropriation, Bakunin's corruption thesis, Kropotkin's mutual aid) holds that the state is intrinsically dominating: obedience is owed to legality, not rightness, so no transitional sovereign is legitimate; abolition must be immediate and coordination achieved by federation. Marxism (P1 state as the executive of class relations; P5 Lenin on the weakest link and the vanguard) holds that the state is a *class* instrument that must be captured and used transitionally -- the dictatorship of the proletariat -- before it 'withers'.

The decisive exchange. Bakunin predicts that a revolutionary workers' state will breed a new ruling stratum; the historical record of transitional states is an adverse residual Marxists must concede. Marxists reply that entrenched property cannot be dissolved without organised political power, and that immediate abolition invites either reconquest by the old order or the return of *hidden authority* (expertise, informal status, economic power) -- anarchism's own strongest internal objection.

Assessment. Anarchism's diagnosis is sharper about the *dangers of concentrated power*; Marxism's is sharper about the *structural tenacity of property*. Neither refutes the other outright: the anarchist critique of transitional power is vindicated by history, while the Marxist critique of premature abolition is vindicated by the persistence of domination without an organising counter-power.

Verdict. On the narrow question 'can we dispense with authority at once?', Marxism is the more defensible; on 'is transitional state power self-limiting?', anarchism's caution is vindicated.

MEMORY: shared enemy + state-as-method split; P9/Bakunin vs P1/P5/Lenin; hidden-authority objection both ways; conditional verdict, not a knock-out.